

FIRST SESSION

Sylvain BAILLY

Trainer printout | English course welcome, needs confirmation and speaking diagnostic

FIRST SESSION Tuesday 30 June 2026 - 14:00	FORMAT Video lesson - Google Meet	COURSE 19 hours 2 x 1h30 / week	CERTIFICATION VTest Business English
CONTRACT END 14 December 2026	PERSONALISED THEMES Professional context, cooking, aeronautics	TRAINER PRIORITIES Listening, speaking, clear structure	TODAY Get acquainted - confirm route - establish a starting point

Trainer reminder

Do not discuss a level label with Sylvain in the first lesson. Use competence-based language instead: “We will build clearer, more confident English for the situations that matter to you.”

A. Before he joins

Keep this page beside the lesson page. The aim is a relaxed, useful first meeting - not a formal test.

- [] Open Google Meet and the Sylvain introduction lesson page.
- [] Keep Digiforma available only for the items he can actually access.
- [] Have the initial assessment and indicative training route nearby.
- [] Prepare a quiet, friendly start: speak slowly, allow pauses and model short answers.
- [] Use French strategically for reassurance or clarification; return to English for the conversation.

B. Your welcome and self-introduction

Use the long version if the conversation starts easily; otherwise begin with the short version.

Short version - around 30 seconds

“Hello Sylvain, it is very nice to meet you. I am Tisha, your English trainer. I grew up in the United States and I have lived in France for more than twenty years. In our lessons, we will work step by step with real situations, practical English and topics that are useful for you. Today, we will simply get to know each other and confirm what will help you make progress.”

Long version - around 60 seconds

“Hello Sylvain, it is very nice to meet you. I am Tisha, your English trainer. I grew up in the United States and I have lived in France for more than twenty years. I work with adults who want to communicate more confidently in English for work, travel and certification. My approach is practical and progressive: you will speak a lot, we will use themes that interest you, and I will help you build clear and natural sentences. Mistakes are completely normal - they show us what to practise next. Today is not a test. It is a chance for us to get to know each other and build a course that really suits you.”

How I work - simple script

“We will work with listening, speaking, reading and writing, but we will give extra attention to speaking and understanding English more easily. We will use professional topics as well as cooking and aeronautics. I will correct the points that will help you most, and we will reuse the same useful language until it feels more natural.”

C. Start of session - connection, agenda and Digiforma

Suggested timing: 0-10 minutes. Keep the explanation brief and practical.

1. Quick technical check - 5 minutes

“Before we start, let us check that the sound and camera are working well. Can you hear me clearly? Can you see me? Is the connection comfortable on your side?”

- ☐ Sound and microphone checked
- ☐ Camera checked
- ☐ Connection stable
- ☐ Headphones / quiet place if helpful
- ☐ Google Meet link works for future sessions

First impressions / technical notes

2. Explain today's plan - 1 minute

“Today, we will get to know each other, talk a little about your work and interests, discuss your English goals and decide how we can work together. At the end, I will summarise the route I suggest for you.”

3. Digiforma - points to explain

How to frame it for the learner

“Digiforma is the training centre’s administrative platform. It helps keep the practical side of your course organised: documents, the timetable, attendance and any questionnaires or progress documents that are assigned to you. It is not an English test. We will keep it simple, and you can tell me or the centre if anything is unclear.”

Trainer note: only show or promise features that CFL has activated in Sylvain’s participant space. The following is a checklist, not a claim about his exact portal configuration.

Point to cover	What to say / check	Done
Access	Can you access the learner area and open the information sent by the centre?	☐
Schedule	Confirm that the rhythm, time and video format are clear. Explain how to report a difficulty or absence.	☐
Documents	Show where course documents or links appear, if this is enabled.	☐
Attendance	Explain that attendance is followed by the training centre. Confirm the practical process only if it has been communicated.	☐
Questionnaires / evaluations	Explain that there may be short feedback or progress documents during or after the course.	☐
Support	Give the practical contact route for a platform or administrative issue: trainer / centre, according to CFL procedure.	☐

Digiforma / administrative notes to follow up

D. Getting to know each other - guided conversation

Suggested timing: 10-28 minutes. Start with easy questions; follow his answers rather than rushing through the list.

Use this progression

- Ask one clear question at a time, then wait.
- When he answers briefly, use a friendly follow-up: “Can you tell me a little more?”
- Offer two choices only when he is blocked: “Do you prefer music or sport?”
- Recast rather than interrupt: repeat his idea back in a clear model sentence.
- Write 5-8 useful words or phrases that come from his real life.

A. Everyday life and family

Ask in English	Support / follow-up	Useful model language
Where do you live?	Town / region? What do you like about it?	I live in ... / I live near ...
Do you live with your family?	Who do you live with?	I live with ... / I live alone.
Do you have children?	How old are they? What do you enjoy doing together?	I have ... children. / I do not have any children.
What do you like doing in your free time?	At weekends? On holiday?	In my free time, I enjoy ...
Can you tell me about a typical week?	Busy? Regular? Flexible?	My week is usually ... because ...

B. Work and professional situation

Ask in English	Support / follow-up	Useful model language
Can you tell me about your work?	Do you work for a company or are you self-employed?	I work as a ... / I run my own business.
What is your job title?	What are your main responsibilities?	My role is to ... / I am responsible for ...
Who do you work with?	Customers? Suppliers? A team?	I work with ... / I often speak to ...
When do you need English at work?	Calls? Emails? Meetings? Travel?	I need English when I ...
What would you like to do more easily in English?	Understand? Speak? Explain? Ask questions?	I would like to be able to ...

Key information and vocabulary collected

E. Interests, preferences and English needs

Suggested timing: 28-42 minutes. These questions create the personalised material for later lessons.

C. Interests and preferences

Ask in English	Support / follow-up	Useful model language
What kind of music do you like?	One style or several? When do you listen to it?	I am into ... / I mainly listen to ...
Do you play or watch any sports?	How often? With whom?	I play ... / I follow ... / I am not really into sport.
Do you enjoy reading?	Books, magazines, news, practical information?	I enjoy reading ... / I do not read very often, but ...
What type of food do you like?	Do you cook? Favourite dish? Restaurant or home cooking?	I like ... and ... / I enjoy cooking ...
What films or series do you enjoy?	Comedy, thriller, documentary, action, science fiction?	I tend to watch ... because ...
What do you not enjoy?	Food, activities, films, music, work situations?	I am not very keen on ... / I do not really like ...

D. Learning preferences and confidence

Ask in English	Support / follow-up	Useful model language
How do you feel when you speak English?	Comfortable? Nervous? Need time to think?	I feel ... when I speak English because ...
Which is more difficult for you: listening, speaking, reading or writing?	Why? Give one example.	The most difficult part for me is ...
What helps you learn best?	Visual support? Repetition? Practical tasks? Grammar explanations?	I learn best when ...
Would you like French support at certain moments?	Vocabulary? Grammar? Instructions?	French support helps me when ...
How much time can you give to short practice between lessons?	5 minutes? 15 minutes? A few times per week?	I can usually practise ...

Useful bridge into his personalised themes

“You mentioned work, cooking and aeronautics. I would like to use these topics throughout the course. Could you tell me what interests you most in each area?”

Preferences / confidence / themes to reuse later

F. Short oral diagnostic - use the interactive page

Suggested timing: 42-52 minutes. This is a conversation activity, not an exam.

Activity: build and say a self-introduction

“Let us use the page to build a short introduction about you. We will choose the information that feels right for you. Then you can read it, change it and say it in your own words. There is no need for perfect English - I simply want to hear which words already feel comfortable and which ones we can work on together.”

Suggested sequence

- [] Choose realistic information together: home, family, work, interests, food, music and films.
- [] Start with the A2 version. Ask him to read it or say it with support.
- [] Move to the A2+/B1 version only if comfortable; encourage connectors such as also, because, however, so, especially and overall.
- [] Let him add one personal detail that matters to him.
- [] Choose three sentences to keep as his personal “success sentences” for the next lesson.

Private observation grid - write examples, not judgments

Look for	What to note	Example / next step
Confidence and pace	Does he answer independently? Need long pauses? Comfortable reading?	
Sentence building	Subject + verb + complement? Word order? Can he link two ideas?	
Past / present / future	Does he choose a tense that matches the time reference?	
Prepositions and articles	Examples to recycle later: in / on / at / to / a / the.	
Pronunciation / intelligibility	Which words need a model or a sound focus?	
Listening response	Can he follow the question? Does he request repetition?	

Correction principle

Do not correct every error. Note 3-5 repeated patterns, then model one or two improved sentences. This protects confidence while giving you useful evidence for the route.

G. Confirm the objectives, explain VTest simply and close the session

Suggested timing: 52-60 minutes. End with a clear, reassuring plan.

1. Confirm objectives - simple script

“Based on what you have told me, I suggest that we focus first on speaking more easily, understanding key details when people speak, and building clearer sentences. We will use your professional context, cooking and aeronautics so that the English is useful and motivating. Does this sound right for you? Is there anything important you would like to add or change?”

Write the confirmed priorities

- ☐ Speaking more confidently and structuring answers
- ☐ Understanding spoken information: dates, times, instructions and key details
- ☐ Consolidating clear sentence structure, past forms and frequent prepositions
- ☐ Professional English in practical exchanges
- ☐ Personalised English around cooking and aeronautics
- ☐ Gradual VTest familiarisation - no pressure in the first sessions

Any objectives to add / change

2. VTest - short explanation for Sylvain

What to say

“At the end of the course, you will take the VTest, which is the English certification planned for your training. It measures how you use English in professional situations. It can include listening, reading, speaking and writing, depending on the version organised for you. The test adapts to the candidate’s responses, so its exact duration varies. We will prepare little by little through short, familiar activities. Today, the important thing is simply to build your confidence and your practical English.”

Trainer reference: current official VTest Business English information describes a modular test with one to four skills. Listed module times are approximately Listening 20-45 minutes, Reading 15-35 minutes, Writing about 28 minutes and Speaking about 18 minutes. Confirm the exact version and timing with CFL before giving a precise duration.

H. Proposed 19-hour route and close

Use this to confirm the route in a clear, reassuring way. It remains adaptable after the first session.

1. Proposed 19-hour route - confirm, then adapt

Hours	Focus	Typical activity
1.5h	First meeting: needs confirmation and oral starting point	Guided conversation, self-introduction builder, confidence check
3h	Core conversation and clear sentences	Present simple, questions, work and everyday-life exchanges
3h	Listening for practical details	Short recordings: dates, times, instructions, appointments and key information
3h	Talking about past experiences	Past simple, connectors and structured stories from real life and work
3h	Professional interaction	Requests, appointments, clarification, customer / supplier / team situations
1.5h	Cooking and food - personalised communication	Describe preferences, recipes, service or a meal; speak naturally
1.5h	Aeronautics and travel - personalised communication	Airport, flights, safety / practical information and topic vocabulary
1.5h	Reading and writing for practical communication	Short emails, messages, instructions and clear responses
1h	VTest review and progress point	Targeted format practice, strategy and final individual feedback

The total is 19 hours. The route is indicative and should be adjusted after the first oral diagnostic and any confirmed professional priorities.

2. Close positively

“Thank you, Sylvain. It was very useful to get to know you today. I will use what you have told me to personalise the course. For next time, please keep your introduction page and add anything you would like me to know. We will use your own words and interests to make English more natural and useful for you.”

After-session actions: update pedagogical sheet / save notes / attendance / send follow-up
